

BOROUGH OF MANHATTAN COMMUNITY COLLEGE
The City University of New York
Department of English

ENGLISH 201: INTRODUCTION TO LITERATURE
3 Credits
IN PERSON CLASS

Dr. Patrick Zwosta

Office Hours: By appointment; also Saturdays for 1 hour after class

Email: pm13zwos@alum.siena.edu

Course Description

This is a course that builds upon skills introduced in English 101. In this course, literature is the field for the development of critical reading, critical thinking, independent research, and writing skills. Students are introduced to literary criticisms and acquire basic knowledge necessary for the analysis of texts (including literary terms and some literary theory); they gain proficiency in library and internet research; and they hone their skills as readers and writers. Assignments move from close readings of literary texts in a variety of genres to analyses that introduce literary terms and broader contexts, culminating in an independent, documented, thesis-driven research paper. By the conclusion of English 201, students will be prepared for the analytical and research-based writing required in upper-level courses across the curriculum; they will also be prepared for advanced courses in literature.

Prerequisites

English 101

Required Texts and Materials

All course materials will be provided for students via Brightspace and/or course handouts.

SKILLS AND HABITS STUDENTS WILL DEVELOP IN THIS COURSE:

- Develop a command of literary terms and their definitions
- Thesis development (the thesis is a position the student clearly takes and then supports and develops throughout the essay or paper) for a literary paper
- Being aware of the audience the student is writing for and the purpose of the essay
- Quoting from and analyzing ideas from literary texts
- Finding and analyzing connections between literary texts and genres
- Essay structure to allow controlled development of a thesis
- MLA in-text citation (both quotation and paraphrase)
- MLA style for titles and papers

Course Requirements

Essay 1: Response Paper to A Doll's House or The Metamorphosis (15 points)

Essay 2: Response Paper for Short Story Unit (15 points)

Essay 3: Response Paper for Film Unit (15 points)

Essay 4: Research Paper (prompt will be given later in semester) (20 points)

Class Participation (25 points)

In Class Presentations (10 points)

Course Policies

- Attendance and Punctuality: You are expected to attend class regularly and on time. More than 2 absences could result in the lowering of your grade or failing the course.
- You are responsible for any work assigned during an absence. If you miss class, you may contact me via email or ask another student what you have missed.
- You must be professional, attentive, and courteous in class.
- Try not to leave the room during class.

- Turn off cell phones and electronic equipment. Remove headphones before entering class.
- No recording devices allowed.
- Academic Adjustments for Students with Disabilities. Students with disabilities who require reasonable accommodations or academic adjustments for this course must contact the Office of Accessibility. BMCC is committed to providing equal access to all programs and curricula to all students.
- BMCC Policy on Plagiarism and Academic Integrity Statement. Plagiarism is the presentation of someone else's ideas, words or artistic, scientific or technical work as one's own creation. Using the idea or work of another is permissible only when the original author is identified. Paraphrasing and summarizing, as well as direct quotations, require citations to the original source. Plagiarism may be intentional or unintentional. Lack of dishonest intent does not necessarily absolve a student of responsibility for plagiarism. Students who are unsure how and when to provide documentation are advised to consult with their instructors. The library has guides designed to help students to appropriately identify a cited work. The full policy can be found on BMCC's web site, www.bmcc.cuny.edu.

RESOURCES FOR STUDENTS:

The Learning Resource Center: To help make your college career a success, the Learning Resource Center (LRC) offers students academic support services to strengthen academic skills and meet their learning needs. The LRC is located in Room S-510 and all services are available free of charge to registered BMCC students. The LRC offers academic coaching, tutoring, workshops and events (especially around final exams time), and computer labs.

Contact:

Tutorial Program: (212) 220-1383

Computer Labs: (212) 220-1381 or 1382

E-Tutoring: (212) 220-1380

Online Tutoring: (212) 220-8359

General Info Email: lrc@bmcc.cuny.edu

Tutoring Email: lrc tutoring@bmcc.cuny.edu

Online Tutoring Email:

onlinetutoring@bmcc.cuny.edu

Hours (while classes are in session)

Monday–Thursday: 8:00 a.m.–10:00 p.m.

Friday: 8:00 a.m.–7:00 p.m.

Saturday: 9:00 a.m.–5:00 p.m.

Sunday: 10:00 a.m.–5:00 p.m.

The BMCC Writing Center at 199 Chambers Street in Room S-510 teaches registered students to think critically, write actively, revise mindfully and proofread carefully. In addition, we provide support for faculty who are incorporating writing pedagogy into their curricula. The Writing Center offers One-to-One Tutoring for Students. A sixty (60) minute, one on one tutorial with a writing professional is at the heart of our service. We teach students to develop, organize, draft, revise, and proofread their work. Make an appointment at <http://www.bmcc.cuny.edu/writingcenter/> or you can also come to our office in room S-510 on the Main Campus or call (212) 220-1384 during business hours to make an appointment.

Tentative Schedule of Readings, Assignments, and Class Work (subject to change, so please keep up to date):

Saturday, January 31:	Introduction to Class
Saturday, February 7:	A Doll's House by Henrik Ibsen
Saturday, February 14:	A Doll's House continued
Saturday, February 21:	A Doll's House continued
Saturday, February 28:	The Metamorphosis by Franz Kafka
Saturday, March 7:	The Metamorphosis continued
Saturday, March 14:	The Metamorphosis continued
Saturday, March 21:	Marquez, "I Only Came to Use the Phone"
	Kincaid, "Girl"
	Tan, "Mother Tongue"
Saturday, March 28:	Film: The Terminator (1984) directed by James Cameron
Saturday, April 4:	Spring Break, no class
Saturday, April 11:	Film screening and discussion continued
Saturday, April 18:	Film: Back to the Future (1985) directed by Robert Zemeckis
Saturday, April 25:	Film: Back to the Future (1985) directed by Robert Zemeckis
Saturday, May 2:	Film discussion continued in relation to American Consumerism
Saturday, May 9:	Last day of class; final wrap-up.
11:59 pm	All papers and presentations due via email by